

RESTAURANT ACTIVATION STRATEGY

PICNIC

Activation Concepts

Three high-impact strategies to generate immediate revenue, build lasting community, and make Picnic the most talked-about table in Philadelphia.

01 — The Omakase Experience

02 — The Founder's Table

03 — The Picnic Table

C O N C E P T 0 1

The Omakase Experience

A three-week theatrical dining series that becomes the talk of the city — and the series that outlives it.

One Chef. One Story. One Night.

The most powerful marketing Picnic can do isn't an ad campaign — it's an event people can't stop talking about. The Omakase Experience is a three-week, high-ticket theatrical dining series built around three of the most compelling chefs in Philadelphia. Each run is unrepeatable. When it's over, it's gone forever.

THE FORMAT	THE SCARCITY	THE MINI-DOC	
6–8 Course Theatrical Journey Each dinner is a full production — lighting, narration, staging — escalating in refinement, culminating in a masterpiece that weaves together the chef's story, the restaurant's identity, and the M Movement's mission.	10–20 Seats. 3–4 Shows. Gone. Each chef runs 3–4 shows before rotating out permanently. When the run ends, that experience ceases to exist. Exclusivity is the price of admission.	Three Chefs. Three Episodes. Each chef's week is an episode — the build-up, the prep, the dinner, the mission. The series runs across socials and the film arm, building toward a document of what Philadelphia's culinary community can do for a cause.	
\$500–\$1K Per Ticket	10–20 Seats Per Night	3 Chefs · 3 Episodes · 3 Weeks	20–30% Revenue to Nonprofit

The Roster

WEEK 01 — NOK SUNTARANON · KALAYA

James Beard Award winner. TIME100 honoree. Netflix Chef's Table. 2025 Michelin-selected. Cookbook named among the best of 2024 by the NY Times and Bon Appétit. Nok opens the series and sets the ceiling. Her story — her mother's market stall in Trang, Thailand, the decades that led to a nationally celebrated restaurant in Fishtown — is the episode that makes everyone understand what this series is really about. She doesn't just sell tickets. She makes the other two weeks sell out before they happen.

WEEK 02 — JOE BEDDIA · PIZZERIA BEDDIA

Bon Appétit named his pizza the best in America in 2015. Time Magazine called the restaurant one of the world's 19 greatest places to eat. 2025 Michelin Bib Gourmand. Joe Beddia is the cult episode — the one nobody sees coming. His stripped-down, obsessive craft philosophy applied to a theatrical multi-course omakase format is the buzzworthy twist that drives press. 40 pies a day, two employees, no chairs, no phone, no compromise. The American underdog chapter.

The Roster, cont.

WEEK 03 — NICK KENNEDY · SURAYA

Michelin-recommended. Co-owner of the restaurant named for Roland Kassis' grandmother — whose hospitality during Lebanon's wartime fed allies and enemies alike. Nick Kennedy is the closing chapter, and it's the one that reframes everything. This isn't just a dinner. It's the origin story of the entire movement — the reason hospitality matters, where it comes from, and what it costs to give it freely. This is the episode that becomes the nonprofit content. The one that travels.

THE CONTENT PLAY

"We have 30 days to turn this around or the doors close forever — by creating something that's never been done before, and will never be done again." The build-up becomes a mini-docuseries for the film arm and socials. The event is the anchor. The content is the amplifier that makes the rest of the world lean in.

C O N C E P T 0 2

The Founder's Table

A curated giving ecosystem built on experience first, investment second.

Sweetener First. Investment Second.

The most powerful asks don't happen in boardrooms. They happen when people are relaxed, inspired, and already feeling something. The Founder's Table leads with an unforgettable experience, then converts that goodwill into immediate, mission-driven revenue — on a self-sustaining quarterly cycle.

PHASE 01

The Trip

10–15 business leaders from Roland's network — warm relationships, not cold contacts — are invited on a four-day luxury retreat. Cabo. Somewhere of that caliber. Hosted upfront, on our dime. No ask yet. Just the right people in the right environment, building genuine connection around the vision.

10–15

Curated Founders

PHASE 02

The Pitch

While there, founders are introduced to the mission driving that quarter's initiative. The setting does the work — relaxed, bought-in, away from the noise. Commitments are made on the trip at the moment of maximum receptivity. The ask happens where it can actually land.

4

Days to Close the Room

PHASE 03

The Table

Committed founders return quarterly to the restaurant — not for another pitch, but for a homecoming. Great food, mission impact updates, a look at what they've contributed to, and a preview of the next trip. The cycle re-ups itself. The community deepens. The mission sustains.

Q

Quarterly, Self-Sustaining

The Founder's Box

THE FOUNDER'S BOX — TIERED IMPACT MODEL

Every commitment unlocks a fleet of Founder's Boxes — curated offerings drawn from across the entire Defined Hospitality portfolio: wood-fired rotisserie and oysters from Picnic, Lebanese pantry staples and mezze from Suraya, Joe Beddia's celebrated pizza from Pizzeria Beddia, and flavors from Condesa, El Techo, and Kalaya. The donation amount determines the volume — the more they give, the wider their reach. Founders deploy their boxes however they choose: gifting to their network, stocking their offices, or donating directly to shelters and meal centers across the city.

IMMEDIATE REVENUE MECHANISM

Every box is billed and fulfilled immediately through Picnic upon commitment — no lag, no waiting. Revenue hits the restaurant the moment the handshake happens. This is the fastest direct injection of capital in the model. Their generosity becomes tangible, visible, and entirely theirs to own.

This isn't a donation model. It's a legacy play — for the city, for the mission, and for every founder at the table.

C O N C E P T 0 3

The Picnic Table

Repositioning Picnic as Philadelphia's premium community dining destination — where strangers become neighbors.

Philadelphia’s Village Table.

In Savannah, Mrs. Wilkes' Dining Room became a legend not because of a marketing campaign — but because of a table. Strangers sat down together, shared plates piled high with food, and left feeling like family. The Picnic Table lifts that spirit, elevates it, and gives Picnic the one identity no competitor in Philadelphia can claim: the intersection of premium dining, community, and cause.

THE EXPERIENCE

Ticketed, Family-Style Communal Dining

Premium family-style spreads — rotisserie chicken, oysters, seasonal sides — served at a large communal picnic table designed to seat strangers side by side. The format is warm and abundant, but the quality and presentation are anything but casual. This is the village table, reimagined for a city that needs one.

THE IDENTITY

Picnic's Distinct Position in the Market

Every local competitor has a table. Picnic has THE table. The communal format, the charity tie-in, the rotating mission — these aren't marketing features, they're a point of view. A transparent 20–30% of every event's revenue goes to that month's nonprofit mission, giving the community a reason to return that's bigger than the food itself.

1 Table

City-Wide Identity

20–30%

Revenue to Monthly Mission

∞

Repeatable · Scalable · Ownable

THE PICNIC TABLE

Three Pillars

THE MENU

Premium & Seasonal

Rotisserie chicken, raw bar, oysters, elevated seasonal sides — abundant, shareable, built to photograph. Every spread is a statement about what Picnic is and what it stands for.

THE MISSION

Rotating Nonprofit Partner

A transparent portion of each event's revenue goes toward that month's rotating nonprofit mission. Guests know what their ticket is doing in the world. That accountability is the brand differentiator.

THE CONTENT

Built to Be Shared

The communal table is a content engine. The faces, the conversations, the spreads, the strangers who showed up and left as something more — this is the story that travels far beyond the room it happened in.

THE POSITIONING STATEMENT

Picnic isn't just a restaurant. It's the place where Philadelphia comes together — over food that's worth showing up for, around a mission worth being part of, at a table that belongs to everyone.

Every city has restaurants. Few have a village table. Philadelphia doesn't have one yet.

T H R E E C O N C E P T S . O N E M I S S I O N .

Revenue. Community. Legacy.

Each concept is designed to generate immediate income for Picnic while building the kind of community, content, and reputation that compounds long after the event ends.

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